non-violent reformism in Pakistan. Hafiz Saeed later explained the group's philosophy, saying:

> Islam propounds both dawa and jihad. Both are equally important and inseparable. Since our life revolves around Islam, therefore both dawa and jihad are essential, we cannot prefer one over the other. This was also the practice of the Prophet (PBUH). If beliefs and morals are not reformed, dawa alone develops into mysticism and jihad alone may lead to anarchy. Therefore recognizing the salience of dawa and jihad, the need is to fuse the two together. This is the only way to bring about change among individuals, society and the world.[9]

The group outlines eight reasons for waging violent jihad, and asserts all Muslims are required to wage or support it until these objectives are met: to eliminate Muslim persecution; to achieve the dominance of Islam as a way of life throughout the entire world; to force disbelievers to pay jizya [a tax on non-Muslims]; to fight those who oppress the weak and feeble; to exact revenge for the killing of any Muslim; to punish enemies for violating their oaths or treaties; to defend Muslim states anywhere in the world; and to recapture occupied Muslim territory. Further, Lashkar considers any state that experienced Muslim rule to be Islamic territory that must be recovered.[10] After the Soviet withdrawal from Afghanistan in 1989, Lashkar militants joined the jihadi caravan and fought on multiple open fronts during the 1990s. Its militants were among the first foreign fighters to participate in the Tajik civil war [1992–1997], though they were not active for the entire conflict.[11] The group also sent cadres to Bosnia-Herzegovina, where they fought under the command of Mahmoud Mohammad Ahmed Bahaziq, known by his kunya [nom de guerre] Sheikh Abu Abdul Aziz and sometimes referred to as Barbaros because of his red beard. A Saudi national of Indian descent (his mother was from Hyderabad), Bahaziq was one of the founders as well as a financier of MDI and headed its Department of External Affairs in the 1990s.[12] He was also one of the first veterans of the anti-Soviet jihad in Afghanistan to travel to Bosnia-Hezegovina and his efforts there helped to inaugurate a wave of fighters to that battlefield.[13] Some belonged to the nascent Lashkar, but most were veterans of the Afghan jihad (known as Arab Afghans), or new volunteers from various Arab countries.[14] An invitation in 1998 to MDI's annual conference lauded Bahaziq for his efforts stating 'Commander Abu Abdul Aziz of Markazul Dawa Wal Irshad laid the foundation of jehad in